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A Specification at a glance

AS Unit 1: Participation in Sport and Recreation

*Unit code 6PE01

- Externally assessed
- Availability: June

50%
of the
total AS
marks

25% of
the total
GCE
marks

Content summary:

The unit content is divided into **two** sections, with each section outlining the specific knowledge and understanding required by the student.

The first section will develop the student's knowledge and understanding of what constitutes a healthy and active lifestyle. Students will investigate how the body responds and adapts to exercise, the components of physical and skill fitness and different methods of fitness training. The rationale behind carrying out fitness assessments and the protocols associated with recognised fitness tests will also be considered.

The second section encourages the student to develop their knowledge and understanding of how competitive sport has developed over time. They will learn how a lifelong involvement in sport is encouraged.

Assessment:

The assessment of this unit is through a 1 hour and 30 minute examination paper which is set and marked by Pearson.

The paper will be a question-and-answer booklet, consisting of short-answer and extended-writing type questions, all of which are compulsory.

AS Unit 2: The Critical Sports Performer

*Unit code 6PE02

- Internally assessed
- Availability: June

50%
of the
total AS
marks

25% of
the total
GCE
marks

Content summary:

The fundamental aim of this unit is to engage participants in **four** tasks. These tasks will offer a framework of opportunities to develop practical experiences and conduct independent research into the structure, provision and analysis of physical activity.

Students will have the chance to offer two performances from a choice of **three** roles (player/participant, leader and official) recording their performance over a period of time.

They will then undertake a study into the provision for all **three** roles at a local level, followed by a study of the provision for one role at the national level.

Lastly, they will produce an analysis of their performance relating to at least one of the activities offered in the first task.

Assessment:

Students must complete all **four** tasks. This unit is internally assessed and externally moderated.

* See *Appendix 3* for description of this code and all other codes relevant to this qualification.

A2 Unit 3: Preparation for Optimum Sports Performance

*Unit code 6PE03

- Externally assessed
- Availability: June

50%
of the
total A2
marks

25% of
the total
GCE
marks

Content summary:

Students will develop a knowledge and understanding of the short- and long-term physiological and psychological preparations made by elite athletes.

They will consider the short- and long-term technical preparations required, eg selection of appropriate kit and equipment, the use of training camps, different types of ergonomic aids.

Assessment:

The assessment of this unit is through a 2-hour examination paper which is set and marked by Edexcel.

The paper will be a question-and-answer booklet, consisting of short-answer and extended-writing type questions, all of which are compulsory.

A2 Unit 4: The Developing Sports Performer

*Unit code 6PE04

- Internally assessed
- Availability: June

50%
of the
total A2
marks

25% of
the total
GCE
marks

Content summary:

The tasks undertaken in *Unit 2: The Critical Sports Performer* lay the foundation for students to specialise in **one** practical performance role and progress this performance, and undertake **three** further tasks.

Students will construct a development plan to further progress their performance as player/ participants, leaders or officials.

They will also research **one** of these roles in an international context, taking in grassroots participation, elite performance and other factors. Students will then continue to refine their performances in **one** chosen role.

Lastly, they will plan their life in physical activity, from the Advanced Subsidiary course to the potential opportunities and performance structure open to them, thereby outlining a 'time line', through school, college, university, club, veterans and future roles.

Assessment:

Students must complete all **four** tasks. This unit is internally assessed and externally moderated.

B Specification overview

Summary of assessment requirements

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 1: Participation in Sport and Recreation	AS	The assessment of this unit is through a 1 hour and 30 minute examination paper which is set and marked by Pearson. The paper will be a question-and-answer booklet and all questions in the paper are compulsory. The paper will consist of short-answer and extended-writing type questions. The total marks for the paper are 90.	90 marks
Unit 2: The Critical Sports Performer	AS	This unit is internally assessed and externally moderated. Students must complete all four tasks. ■ Task 2.1 (Personal Performance) requires students to participate in two performances from a choice of three roles (player/participant, leader and official) for example, students could participate as a player/participant in two different activities, or as a leader in one activity and a player/participant in another activity. This task is designed to develop their practical performances as player/participants, leaders or officials. This task is marked out of 30. ■ Task 2.2 (Local Study) requires students to undertake independent research into the provision (access, opportunities, funding, resources), locally, for one physical activity in all three roles (see unit). This task is marked out of 15. ■ Task 2.3 (National Study) builds on Task 2.2 by extending a student's opportunities to research the national provision, at elite levels, in at least one of their chosen roles. This task is marked out of 15. ■ Task 2.4 (Performance Analysis) draws heavily on Task 2.1, requiring students to research the methodology and applied processes intrinsic to the completion of an analysis of performance. This analysis can be in either of the student's two selected practical performances. While reflective in nature, it is envisaged that the skills and understanding acquired will provide for further student development. This task is marked out of 30. The total number of marks for each task is listed above. One overall mark out of 90 is required. Students must be assessed in line with the published instructions for assessment and the assessment criteria for the task.	90 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
Unit 3: Preparation for Optimum Sports Performance	A2	The assessment of this unit is through a 2-hour examination paper which is set and marked by Pearson. The paper will be a question-and-answer booklet and all questions in the paper are compulsory. The paper will consist of short-answer and extended-writing type questions. The total marks for the paper are 90.	90 marks
Unit 4: The Developing Sports Performer	A2	This unit is internally assessed and externally moderated. Students must complete all four tasks. ■ Task 4.1 (Development Plan) requires students to plan, research, perform, record, review and evaluate a development plan for one of the roles taken for Task 2.1 (Personal Performance). The development plan will be unique to the individual and will show students how to realise and progress their performance. This task is further divided into three components: ◆ component one — planning and researching ◆ component two — performing and recording ◆ component three — review and evaluation. Components one and two are marked out of 20, and component three is marked out of 5, to give an overall mark out of 45. This mark should be compared against the holistic criteria to ensure an accurate grade is awarded. ■ Task 4.2 (International Study) engages students through independent research and establishes, by expanding on Task 2.2: Local Study and Task 2.3: National Study, a knowledge and understanding of the opportunities and provisions for mass participation and elite development in another nation. This task is marked out of 15. ■ Task 4.3 (Progressive Participation) provides further routes for a student to undertake continued participation in one chosen role and through progressive practices and competition refine this performance. This task is marked out of 20. ■ Task 4.4 (Life Plan) requires students to write a 'life plan', the development of which requires independent research into their opportunities for participation. Students should consider different 'age stages', and how they will seek both continued and alternative sporting participation in a variety of roles. This task is marked out of 10.	90 marks

Unit number and unit title	Level	Assessment information	Number of marks allocated in the unit
		The total number of marks for each task is listed above. One overall mark out of 90 is required. Students must be assessed in line with the published instructions for assessment and the assessment criteria for the task.	

Assessment objectives and weightings

		% in AS	% in A2	% in GCE
A01	Students should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of physical activity	40.5%	27%	33.75%
A02	Students should demonstrate the ability to apply skills, knowledge and understanding in physical activity	40.5%	35.5%	38%
A03	Students should demonstrate the ability to analyse and evaluate critically physical activity	19%	37.5%	28.25%
TOTAL		100%	100%	100%

Relationship of assessment objectives to units

Unit number	Assessment objective			
	A01	A02	A03	Total for A01, A02 and A03
Unit 1	10.5%	7.75%	6.75%	25%
Unit 2	9.75%	12.5%	2.75%	25%
Unit 3	6.5%	9.5%	9%	25%
Unit 4	7%	8.25%	9.75%	25%
Total for Advanced GCE	33.75%	38%	28.25%	100%

Qualification summary

Subject criteria

The General Certificate of Education is part of the Level 3 provision. This specification is based on the Advanced Subsidiary GCE and Advanced GCE Subject criteria for Physical Education which are prescribed by the regulatory authorities and are mandatory for all awarding bodies.

Aims

The aims of the GCE in Physical Education are to:

- 1 encourage students to become increasingly **physically competent** by:
 - developing the skills and techniques they require to perform effectively in physical activities
 - applying and adapting a wide range of skills and techniques effectively in different types of physical activity
 - developing and applying their skills in different roles, such as performer, leader and official within physical activities
 - applying their skills in different contexts within a physical activity.
- 2 **enable students to maintain and develop their involvement and effectiveness in physical activity through:**
 - developing their knowledge and understanding of factors that enable them and others to be physically active
 - as part of a balanced lifestyle
 - as part of a lifelong involvement in an active and healthy lifestyle
 - developing their knowledge and understanding of the relationship between skill, strategy/composition, and body and mind readiness in ensuring effective and efficient performance in their own and others' roles such as performer, leader and official.

3 enable students to be **informed and discerning decision makers who understand how to be involved in physical activity** through helping them to:

- understand how they and others make the most of the opportunities and pathways available to be involved in physical activity
- understand and critically evaluate how contemporary products and consumer-focused influences related to physical activity affect and inform young people's decisions about being involved in a range of physical activities
- understand and critically evaluate current key influences that might limit or encourage young people's involvement in physical activity.

AS/A2 knowledge and understanding

This Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE specification requires students to demonstrate a knowledge and understanding of:

- healthy and active lifestyles
- opportunities and pathways within the sports industry
- sport provision within the local and international arena
- preparation required to achieve elite performance
- personal development.

AS/A2 skills

This Advanced Subsidiary and Advanced GCE specification requires students to:

- communicate ideas and information
- evaluate
- apply skills in physical activity
- plan
- review.

C Edexcel GCE Physical Education unit content

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Unit 2 The Critical Sports Performer	23
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Unit 3 Preparation for Optimum Sports Performance	41
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Course structure

- The Pearson Edexcel Level 3 GCE in Physical Education comprises four units and contains an Advanced Subsidiary subset of two AS units.
- The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is the first half of the GCE course and consists of Units 1 and 2. It may be awarded as a discrete qualification or contribute 50 per cent of the total Advanced GCE marks.
- The full Advanced GCE award consists of the two AS units (Units 1 and 2), plus two A2 units (Units 3 and 4) which make up the other 50 per cent of the Advanced GCE. Students wishing to take the full Advanced GCE must, therefore, complete all four units.
- The structure of this qualification allows teachers to construct a course of study which can be taught and assessed either as:
 - ◆ distinct modules of teaching and learning with related units of assessment taken at appropriate stages during the course; or
 - ◆ a linear course which is assessed in its entirety at the end.